

Koustuv Saha

 koustuv-saha-71b284b6 |  sahakoustuv.github.io |  ksaha@aus.edu |  +971-50-658-3412

EDUCATION

- 2021–2025 **Ph.D. Agricultural Economics**, Purdue University, Indiana, USA
Dissertation: *Essays on Women's Work and Agency in Agriculture*
Advisors: Dr. Kajal Gulati, Dr. Jacob Ricker-Gilbert
- 2017–2019 **M.Phil. Development Studies**, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research, Mumbai, India
- 2014–2016 **M.Sc. Economics**, University of Calcutta, India
- 2011–2014 **B.Sc. Economics**, University of Calcutta, India

WORK EXPERIENCE

- Postdoctoral Researcher**, American University of Sharjah 2025–July 2026
- Graduate Research Assistant**, Purdue University 2021–2025
- Research Associate**, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research 2017–2020

AWARDS

- Uma Lele Prize for Best Contributed Paper on Gender, International Conference for Agricultural Economics, 2024. *For paper titled "Women's Work and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India"*.
- Ludwig Kruhe Fellowship, Purdue University (USD 68,766), 2024. *Awarded to the most outstanding graduate students across seven departments.*
- UGC Junior Research Fellowship, Government of India, 2017. *Awarded to top 6% of candidates nationally.*

PUBLICATIONS

- Gulati, K., **Saha, K.**, & Lybbert, T.J. (2025). "Women's Work and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India." *American Journal of Agricultural Economics*. doi.org/10.1111/ajae.12536 *Awarded Uma Lele Prize for Best Paper.*
- Saha, K.**, Pandey, V.L., & Dev, S.M. (2023). "Women's Land Ownership and Household Decisions: Implications for Child Health in Rural India." In *Axes of Sustainable Development and Growth in India*. Springer Nature. doi.org/10.1007/978-981-19-9756-3_8

JOB MARKET PAPER

Strategy and Coordination in Risky Household Decisions

Abstract: Do spouses successfully coordinate risk-taking decisions in the household? This paper uses a lab-in-field experiment between married couples in Bangladesh to show that most people hold mistaken beliefs about their spouse's risk-taking behavior. In a sequential lottery-choice game husbands and wives each chose one lottery and shared the total winnings. Under imperfect information about their spouse's choice, only about one in four subjects successfully coordinate their choice their spouse's choice so to achieve their intended lottery portfolio for the household. Biased beliefs about the spouse's choice, led 23% of subjects to accept excessively risky lotteries and 24% to sacrifice profitable opportunities out of over-caution. Larger biases occur when a subject's spouse actively tries to counter or ignore their choice, a behavior typically shown by men. As a result, household portfolios more often reflect men's risk preferences. When one spouse exhibits this tendency, the other often mirrors it, compounding coordination failure within the household. Linking experimental behavior to real-world outcomes, I combine the experiment with rich data on household investment and saving behavior. I find evidence of asymmetric information between spouses regarding pecuniary savings, physical assets, and outstanding loans.

Coordination errors in the experiment predict biased beliefs about spouse's savings for different purposes like investment into children and for emergencies. Crucially, larger coordination errors significantly increase the likelihood that a household was unable to cope with an adverse shock in the past twelve months using available resources, forcing it to sell productive assets or resort to migration.

WORKING PAPERS

Saha, K., Gulati, K., & Bird, S. "Agricultural Mechanization and Gendered Structural Transformation in India."

Saha, K., Yadav, S, & **Saha, K.** "Gender Role Attitudes and Female Labor Participation: Evidence from Egypt"

Atallah, S., Dissanayake, S., Lopes, A.A., & **Saha, K.** "Indigenous Communities and Species Conservation – Examining the Role of Nature-Based Practices in Promoting Ecosystem Services."

Saha, K., Lopes, A.A., & Tasneem, D. "Prickly Neighbors: Religion, Risk, and Human–Wildlife Coexistence."

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Soil Moisture Thresholds and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India." (With Soumik Paul)

"Cross-country Analysis of Diet Affordability and Nutrition Outcomes." (With Soumya Gupta, Adrian Lopes & Adaleeb Rahman)

"Data-driven Approach to Selecting Structurally Similar Donor Pool for SCM." (With Pattawee Puangchit)

GRANTS

Rolling Research Grant, American University of Sharjah (USD 16,338), 2025-26. Role: Co-principal Investigator.

Jim and Neta Hicks Graduate Student Grant, Purdue University (USD 7,500), 2023.

AAEA Travel Grant 2025.

Purdue Graduate Student Government (PGSG) Travel Grant, 2024.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting. New Orleans, LA July 2024
"Agricultural mechanization and gendered structural transformation in India."

Pacific Conference for Development Economics. Stanford University, Stanford, CA March 2024
"Women's Work and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India"

REFEREEING EXPERIENCE

Agricultural Economics, Review of Development Economics, International Social Science Journal

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant AGECE 217: Introductory Economics (Undergraduate) 2024

Teaching Assistant Econometrics I (Graduate) 2018

TECHNICAL & LANGUAGE SKILLS

Analytical	STATA (Expert), R (Advanced), GAMS (Intermediate), Python (Intermediate), QGIS (Intermediate), Julia (Intermediate)
Survey	SurveyCTO, Survey Solutions
Field Experience	Bangladesh, India
Language	English (Professional fluency), Bengali (Native), Hindi (Conversational)

REFERENCES

Dr. Kajal Gulati	Assistant Professor, AFRE, Michigan State University gulatik4@msu.edu
Dr. Jacob Ricker-Gilbert	Professor, Agricultural Economics, Purdue University jrickerg@purdue.edu
Dr. Colin D. Sullivan	Assistant Professor, Economics, University of Pittsburgh colindsullivan@pitt.edu